

◆ FIRST LIGHT

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

Genre: Survival / Exploration · First-Person · Space | Platform: PC | Engine: Unity URP

CONCEPT

The player finds themselves drifting in open space after their spacecraft has crashed. The only hope is to hold on long enough for a rescue team to find them. Somewhere in the darkness, a light flickers — **First Light** — a beacon or a star that might lead to salvation. But first, you have to survive.

GOAL

- Collect oxygen canisters scattered among the wreckage
- Avoid dangerous cosmic objects
- Scan the surroundings for a rescue signal
- First Light is not just a landmark — it is hope

GAMEPLAY

Core Loop

1. Oxygen depletes continuously over time
2. The player searches for oxygen canisters in the environment
3. Hazardous objects create danger and accelerate oxygen drain

4. Survive as long as possible

Controls

- **WASD / Arrow Keys** — movement (jetpack)
- **Hold RMB** — look around (mouse)

Oxygen System

- Drains continuously over time
- Drains faster near hazardous objects
- Replenished by canisters distributed across the level
- Reaching zero ends the game

Oxygen Canisters

- Randomly scattered in space around the wreckage
- Play a sound effect and animation on pickup
- Can be single-use or respawn after a cooldown

HAZARDS

Object	Danger
Nebula	Increases oxygen drain rate when nearby
Pulsar	Intense radiation — strongly accelerates oxygen loss
Black Hole	Maximum danger; audio and visual alarm on approach; collision = instant game over

All hazards feature gradual threat escalation by proximity, audio warnings, and visual feedback (vignette, screen distortion).

ATMOSPHERE & FEEDBACK

The player constantly feels the character's condition through:

- **Breathing** — rate changes based on oxygen level
- **Helmet vignette** — darkens at low oxygen
- **Visor frost** — appears at critical oxygen levels
- **Geiger counter** — audio ticking near hazardous objects
- **Music layers** — tension rises with danger
- **Stardust particles** — flow around the nearest object

GAME OVER CONDITIONS

Defeat

Oxygen = 0 → death screen, option to play again
Collision with a Black Hole → instant game over

Victory / Next Level

The player moves toward the source of light (First Light) hoping for rescue. Upon reaching it — the truth is revealed to be something absurd:

- A broken flashlight drifting through space
- A bioluminescent deep-sea fish that somehow ended up in outer space
- Some other random glowing object

But... behind it, another First Light flickers. The player advances to the next level — and the cycle repeats, each time harder.

FIRST LIGHT

First Light is a mysterious source of light on the horizon. The player sees it and wonders: a rescue expedition? A living creature that can help? Something that will lead them out of this nightmare?

Mechanically — it is the level objective. Reaching it = completing the level.

Narratively — each time it turns out to be something absurd and unexpected, but beyond it another light always glimmers.

Tone: a little bitter, a little funny. Hope that turns out to be a flashlight. But you keep walking toward the next one.

UI / HUD

- **Oxygen bar** — left side, changes color: white → yellow → red
- **Distance to nearest object** — right side
- **Intro popup** — explains the situation at game start

LEADERBOARD

Stored locally in a JSON file (not in the scene) — this avoids git merge conflicts entirely.

Entry Structure

- Player name
- Survival time (seconds)
- Level reached
- Date

Implemented via `LeaderboardManager.cs` + `leaderboard.json` stored in `Application.persistentDataPath`. No scene storage — only scripts, which merge cleanly in git.

SCENES

Scene	Description
MainMenu	3D environment with planets, Start / Quit buttons
GameScene	Main gameplay in open space

Leaderboard

High score table (optional separate scene)